



Saint Columban College
College of Computing Studies
Pagadian City



Insp3ctor

Insp3ct0r 



Easy

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2019

AUTHOR: ZARATEC/DANNY

Description

Kishor Balan tipped us off that the following code may need inspection:

<http://fickle-tempest.picoctf.net:54033>

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is: **RUNNING**

Instance Time Remaining: **29:49**

[Restart Instance](#)

Hints

1 2

There's 3 parts

164,708 users solved



92%

Liked



 picoCTF{FLAG}

[Submit Flag](#)

Author: The Analyst: Hyposelenia

Challenge: Insp3ctor

Category: Web Exploitation

Date: 02/10/26



I. Objective

The objective of this challenge is to inspect different components of a website—HTML, CSS, and JavaScript—to locate and combine multiple parts of a hidden flag.

II. Background

Web exploitation challenges often involve analyzing the **client-side components** of a website, such as **HTML, CSS, and JavaScript**. These technologies work together in a hierarchical structure: HTML defines the content, CSS controls the design, and JavaScript adds interactivity.

Because these files are delivered to the user's browser, any sensitive information stored within them can be accessed using browser developer tools. This challenge demonstrates how information can be unintentionally exposed across multiple client-side files rather than in a single location.

III. Tool Used

- **Web Browser Developer Tools (Inspect / DevTools)** – Used to inspect HTML, CSS, and JavaScript source files

IV. Methodology

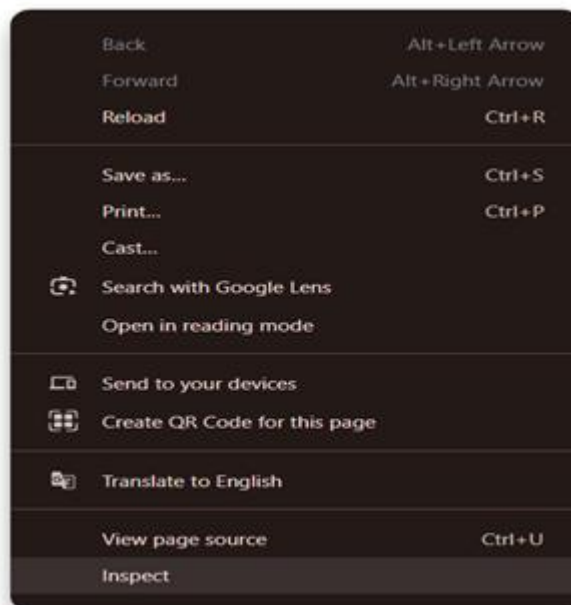
1. Launched the challenge instance on the platform.
2. Accessed the provided website using a web browser.



3. Explored the website and clicked the “**H**ow” section.



4. Suspected that the flag was hidden within the website’s source code based on the challenge hints.
5. Opened the browser’s developer tools by right-clicking and selecting **I**nspect.

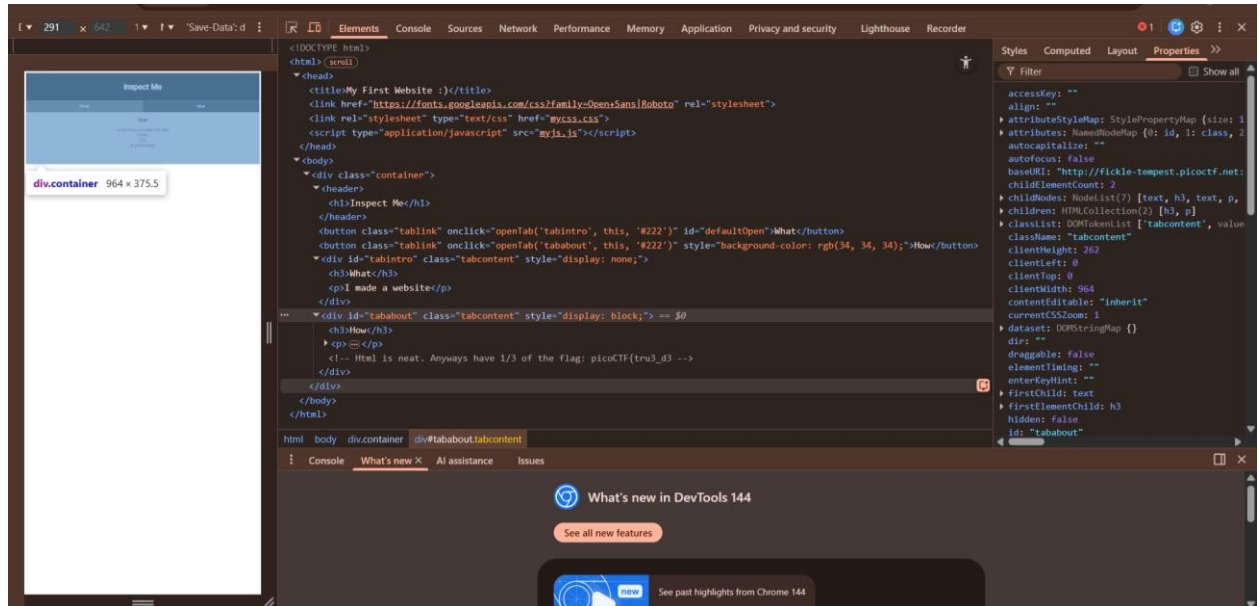




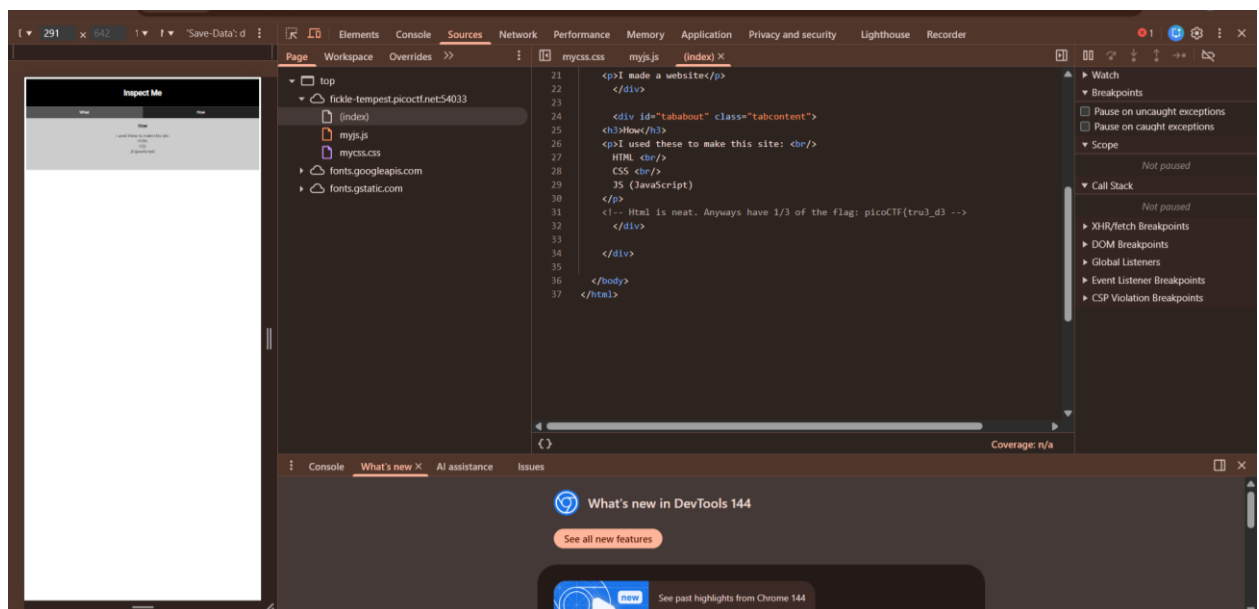
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6. Examined the **Elements** tab and located the first part of the flag within the HTML. (**picoCTF{tru3_d3}**)

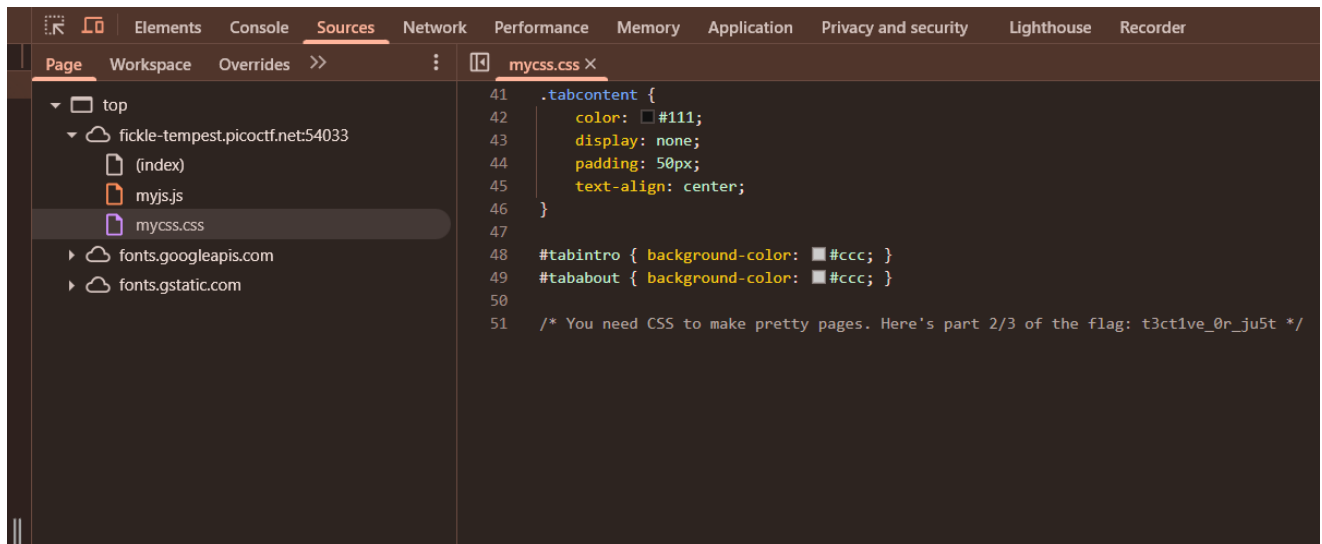


You can also go to Sources Tab, it's much easier.





7. Navigated to the **Sources** tab and opened the CSS file, where the second part of the flag was found. (t3ct1ve_0r_ju5t)



8. Opened the JavaScript file in the Sources tab and identified the final part of the flag. ()_lucky?302945a7}



9. Combined all three parts to form the complete flag.
10. Submitted the reconstructed flag successfully.



V. Result

`picoCTF{tru3_d3t3ct1ve_0r_ju5t_lucky?302945a7}`

VI. Explanation

The challenge title, “**Insp3ctor**,” directly hints at the use of browser inspection tools. Additionally, the website name, “*My First Website*,” suggests a beginner-level implementation where information may be exposed in the source code.

Another important hint indicated that the flag was divided into **three parts**, encouraging exploration beyond just the HTML. By inspecting the HTML, CSS, and JavaScript files individually, each portion of the flag was discovered. This highlights how sensitive information can be unintentionally spread across multiple client-side files.

VII. Conclusion

The Insp3ctor challenge reinforces the importance of understanding how websites are structured and how browser developer tools can be used to analyze them. It demonstrates a common web security weakness—placing sensitive information in client-side code—and emphasizes why such data should be handled securely on the server side. Mastering these inspection techniques is essential for solving more advanced web exploitation challenges.

— **The Analyst: Hyposelenia**